

of my path ahead. Going forward, once I joined the Hartek Group, I founded two sister companies within a period of one year.

Wanting to make an impact

The businesses that have been built over the last ten to twenty years in India are all based on our wants and not our needs. Water, electricity, food and shelter are our basic needs, but nobody is really working on these. Lack of such amenities motivated me to work really hard and do something for the country.

The vision I had for the company was clear, but another incident inspired me to work hard for this sector. Back in 2014-15, I got the opportunity to stay in a village for seven to eight months while I was working on building a 50MW solar sub-station. That is when I saw that people did not have access to basic needs like electricity and water, and that their daily lives were really tough. I realised that the poor in India had to struggle a lot to get something as basic as water, and that was a real eye-opener for me.

The journey so far

The biggest motivation for me to join the Hartek Group was to solve problems and impact people's lives. In fact, the mission statement of Hartek is Making Your Future Powerful. So when I am installing a rooftop solar panel that saves electricity and helps create a sustainable ecosystem, I am solving a problem. The profit or reward that I earn is nothing but a by-product.

When I was at Schneider Electric, I got the opportunity to understand the challenges faced by the power industry in India. And from there, ideas began to form on how to take the Hartek Group forward and, eventually, I set up Hartek Solar. I never wanted to be a liability to the family business; rather, I preferred to create something different for it. I strongly follow one ideology which was taught to me by my father, that is, "The family is for the business, but the business is not for the family."

Recently, I made it to Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia list. Forbes had come out with a form that asked for the kind of social impact our work had on people and on the environment from an economic point of view. They considered these and various other factors

regarding our work. I am immensely humbled that my work got recognition from such a prestigious international organisation.

Best management practices

I am a very disciplined person who is extremely particular about punctuality. Hence I implement that at the office too, among all colleagues. At our headquarters in Chandigarh, work culture is pretty informal. We all usually work with no separate cabins and there is only one floor where the entire team sits together. The whole idea is to empower young people to work on our vision.

The family is for the business, but the business is not for the family

For me, trust, empowerment and integrity are very important to run an organisation efficiently. If you have to build a billion dollar enterprise or a Fortune 500 company, then you have to have trust in your people. Everyone makes mistakes. However, this trust is reciprocated when your team recognises your efforts. To empower a team mate, one has to simply stop micromanaging things. If I define my responsibilities, then I have to stick with them. The Indian Army defines integrity as "doing the right thing when no one is watching." I strongly believe in this. I believe that dishonesty and a lack of trust have no place in my team.

Preferred behavioural traits

I think being honest is very important in any profession. In the earlier days, things were simple. But nowadays things have become very complicated in every aspect.

I appreciate simple and straightforward people, who can stand up to you and say what they think is correct.

Having people in an organisation who always agree with you on everything (even though what you suggest is wrong) is highly dangerous. So unless there is healthy diversity of opinions within a team or organisation, there can be no scope for learn-

ing something new. I am drawn to people who are very comfortable being themselves.

Major contributions to the industry

In the last 28-29 years of the Hartek Group, the whole idea has been to create power grids and sub-stations to provide electricity and help thousands of people. Every project we do is an achievement in its own way.

Second, formation of Hartek Solar has impacted the lives of people in a big way. We receive hundreds of messages from people thanking us for saving electricity costs and providing green energy solutions. All this makes us feel really good about the work we are doing, and motivates us to work even harder.

Third, we have launched Grid Doctor, which is an ambulance for power grids. This enables us to resolve issues whenever any outages occur or other problems crop up.

Another mobile service we have launched is called Solar Van for resolving solar power issues. All this helps us in making our consumers happy and putting a smile on their faces.

Future dreams

On the personal front, I want to give back to this industry through talks on motivation, entrepreneurship and similar other topics, at various colleges and seminars that I frequently attend as a public speaker. Currently, I am a guest faculty member at S.P. Jain Institute of Management and Research. So if I get the opportunity to teach and impart knowledge on the subjects that I am good at, I would love to do that as well. This way, society can benefit from what I have to offer.

On the professional front, I would like to turn the Hartek Group into a Fortune 500 company. No matter how long it takes, I am determined to do so.

The late Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam emphasised the importance of giving back to society before one departs. I too would like to contribute towards better education and healthcare systems, and thus make the youth of our country capable enough to solve complex issues. **EFY**

Please read August 2019 issue of Electronics Bazaar for the full story